# 2013 Toyota Corolla (salvage title)

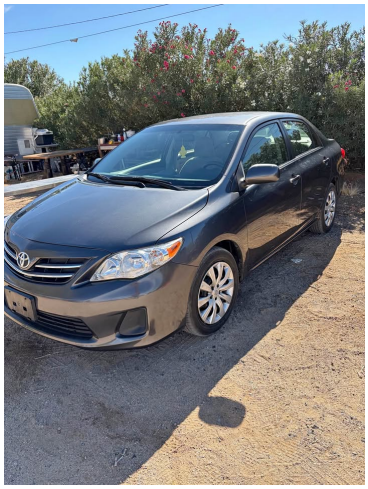
$7,200 · 120,414 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

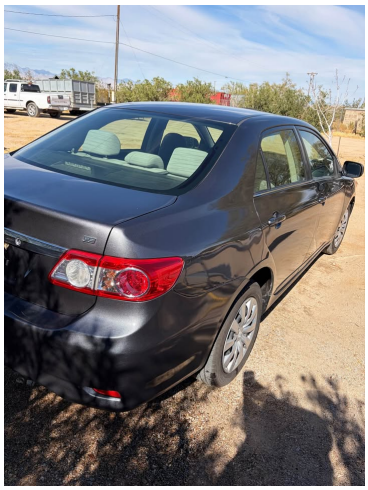
Source: Facebook Marketplace

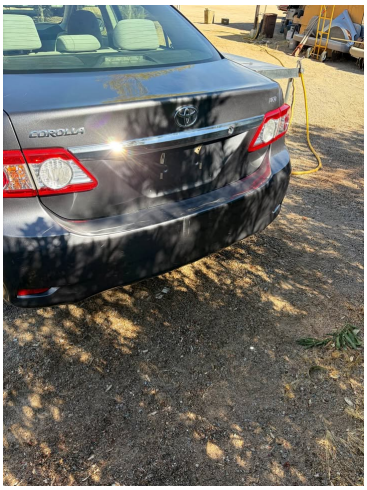
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1736843237388414/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 2 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$8,101** | **$502** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 5 recalls · 201 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $7,200.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $666.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $46.80 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $8,100.80 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $3,100.80 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $62.13 |
| Total interest over the loan | $627.22 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $62.13 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $158.33 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $130.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $16.40 |
| Total per month | $501.87 |

Running costs without the loan: **$440/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,742** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

2013 Corolla 1.8 (2ZR-FE) with the 4-speed automatic is one of the most durable cheap commuters. The salvage title is the main risk: unknown frame or airbag repair, harder to insure full-coverage, lower resale.

NHTSA data for this model year: 5 recalls · 201 owner complaints (46 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (72), Steering (39), Service Brakes (24), Vehicle Speed Control (18), Engine (16), Unknown Or Other (15).

**Known issues for this model**

• Salvage title: damage and repair quality unknown

• Some 2ZR engines burn oil past 150k

• Water pump weep around 100–150k

• 4-speed auto, highway rpm is high

**Check on this car before buying**

• Get VIN, run Copart/IAAI and NHTSA recalls

• Inspect frame rails, airbag lights, panel gaps

• Check oil level and color

• Confirm the smog certificate and title paperwork

## Notes

Added 2026-10-30. Listed 10/29. Automatic 1.8L, 120k mi, SALVAGE title, smog passed, tires good. Seller is a Ridgecrest repair shop with 21 good reviews. $7,200 is high for a salvage car: a clean-title 2013 Corolla with 120k is about $8–9k, and salvage usually sells 20–40% under clean. Offer about $5,500. Ask for the VIN and what the damage was, then check Copart/IAAI history and get the $185 Toyota of Ridgecrest inspection like the Prius.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.